Conflict Carry-Through to Home Evolution at FAI Dissolution

Series D — Paper 3 Derivation Notes · Note D1.16 · #481

Parent claim: D0.03 (Paper 3 Claim 3 — Three-tier inter-Self conflict-handling mechanism)

Position: Fourth sub-commitment of Claim 3; closes the Claim 3 sub-commitment set (D1.13–D1.16)

Wenxin Li (Independent Researcher)

ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235

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Attribution

This work derives from and formalizes the inter-Self coordination architecture introduced in "Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration" (Li, April 2026), the third paper in the CKS theory series following "Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems" (Li, April 2026) and "The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model" (Li, April 2026).

Abstract

D1.16 formalizes the conflict carry-through sub-commitment of Paper 3 Claim 3: when conflicts are preserved during a Full Aspect Integration (FAI) event rather than resolved or escalated, those conflicts do not disappear at dissolution. They carry through to each participating Self's home substrate as action-layer annotations, becoming governance-actionable input to home action-feedback evolution. The annotation records both sides of the preserved conflict, the provenance of the FAI event from which it arose, the contributing aspects of each participating Self, and the fact of preservation rather than resolution. Carry-through is symmetric: every participating Self receives the annotation regardless of which Self's aspect specification is involved in the conflict. The annotation does not resolve the conflict; it signals a governance-worthy boundary that home action-feedback evolution reads as evidence and home directed selection may respond to under home governance authority. D1.16 also sits at the boundary between Claim 3 and Claim 4: the carry-through annotation is one form of Claim 4's four-locus evolution feed at the action-feedback locus (Locus 1), making the architectural coherence between the two claims visible. This note closes the four-note Claim 3 sub-commitment set and identifies four failure modes the sub-commitment defends against.

1. Why conflict carry-through is an architectural commitment

Paper 3 Claim 3 establishes three tiers of conflict handling at the inter-Self perimeter: conflicts surfaced during FAI events are preserved as first-class substrate state, resolved via orchestration rules authored under joint authority, or escalated to humans where no automated resolution is permitted. The preserve tier (formalized in D1.13) is the architectural default: when neither the resolve nor the escalate condition is met, conflicts remain in the shared substrate as addressed, first-class state rather than being silently discarded.

A question immediately follows: what happens to preserved conflicts when the FAI event ends? Shared substrates are event-bounded. At dissolution, the shared substrate closes and participating Selves return to operating under their respective home governance perimeters. If no specific commitment is made about preserved conflicts at dissolution, the default is information loss. The conflict existed as substrate state during the event; at dissolution, with the shared substrate gone, it is simply absent from any subsequent governance context.

This is the gap D1.16 fills. The conflict carry-through sub-commitment is the architectural specification that preserved conflicts do not vanish at dissolution but instead produce action-layer annotations in each participating Self's home substrate. The annotations are the mechanism by which the boundary signal a preserved conflict carries — the signal that two Selves' governance approaches diverge at a specific domain — reaches each Self's home governance as actionable information.

Without the carry-through commitment, the preserve tier would be operationally incomplete. Preserving conflicts as first-class substrate state during an FAI event would be a within-event commitment only, with no architectural pathway for the conflict information to influence each Self's subsequent behavior. Carry-through is what gives preservation its downstream value: a preserved conflict is not merely a record of disagreement during an event but an input to each Self's ongoing evolution.

2. The sub-commitment stated precisely

D1.16 — Conflict Carry-Through to Home Evolution: When a conflict arising during an FAI event is preserved under Claim 3's preserve tier, that conflict produces an action-layer annotation in each participating Self's home substrate at FAI dissolution. The annotation is action-layer content subject to home governance. It is read by each Self's home action-feedback evolution machinery as evidence and may generate improvement proposals for home governance to consider. Carry-through is symmetric: every participating Self in the FAI event receives the annotation, not only the Self whose aspect specification was in tension with another.

Three properties of this sub-commitment deserve explicit notice.

First, the temporal trigger is dissolution, not resolution. The annotation appears in each home substrate when the FAI event closes, whether or not the conflict was resolved during the event. Carry-through applies specifically to preserved conflicts — those not dispatched by the resolve or escalate tiers during the event's active phase.

Second, the annotation is action-layer content in each home substrate. This locates it precisely within Paper 2's layer structure: action-layer content records what operational patterns have been tried, what outcomes followed, and what evidence exists for directed selection to consider. An annotation recording a preserved inter-Self conflict sits in that layer as one form of operational evidence — evidence that a boundary exists at a particular coordination domain.

Third, the annotation carries the full informational content of the preserved conflict, including both sides. The governance value of carry-through depends on this completeness. An annotation that records only one Self's aspect specification, or only the fact of disagreement without the content of both sides, would not give home governance sufficient information to evaluate whether its own approach should evolve in light of the encounter.

3. Annotation content: four required fields

A conflict carry-through annotation must contain four categories of information to satisfy the D1.16 sub-commitment.

Both sides of the preserved conflict. The annotation records each participating Self's aspect specification in the domain of the conflict — what each Self contributed, exactly, such that the conflict arose. This completeness is what allows home governance to evaluate the divergence rather than simply note its existence. An annotation carrying only one Self's specification would deprive home governance of the comparator.

FAI event provenance. The annotation records a link back to the FAI event from which it arose: which event, when, and under what configuration. Provenance serves two functions. It maintains the accountability chain that Paper 1's path-retraceability commitment requires, now extended to the inter-Self boundary. It also enables a Self's home governance to retrieve additional context about the event if the annotation alone is insufficient to characterize the conflict fully.

Contributing aspects identified. The annotation records which aspects from which participating Selves generated the conflicting specifications. Aspect-level identification is what allows home governance to route the annotation appropriately within its own multi-level structure — to the aspect responsible for the domain in question, rather than treating the annotation as an undifferentiated governance item.

Preservation status. The annotation records that the conflict was preserved — not resolved by orchestration rules, not escalated to humans — and that it accordingly requires attention under home governance. This status field is what distinguishes a carry-through annotation from other forms of action-layer content: it marks the entry as arriving from the inter-Self boundary under the preserve tier, rather than as an in-home operational outcome.

4. The governance value: conflict boundary signal as improvement opportunity

The core governance value of conflict carry-through is that a preserved inter-Self conflict is a precisely located boundary signal. When Self A and Self B contribute aspects to an FAI event and those aspects conflict in a preserved way — when orchestration rules do not dispatch the conflict and escalation was not triggered — the conflict marks a place where the two Selves' governance approaches diverge at a specific coordination domain. That divergence is not necessarily an error. It may reflect legitimate specialization, differing operational contexts, or legitimately different approaches to the same domain. But it is information, and carry-through is the mechanism that brings it to each Self's home governance as addressable evidence.

When the annotation appears in Self A's home action layer, it presents a governance-facing question: does Self A's approach to this coordination domain serve its own operational goals well, given that Self B's approach differs? The annotation does not answer this question, and it does not require Self A to converge toward Self B's approach. The authority to evaluate and respond resides entirely within Self A's home governance. But the annotation makes the evaluation possible. Without it, Self A's home governance would have no record that a boundary was encountered, no information about what Self B's approach was, and no basis for considering whether Self A's approach should evolve.

Home action-feedback evolution reads the annotation as evidence in the same way it reads other action-layer content: as a record of operational encounter to which a proposing substrate (Paper 2, B1.15) may respond by generating an improvement proposal. The proposal enters the home governance structure under the same directed selection mechanism that governs all action-feedback evolution — it does not act on Self A's behavior automatically. The human authority that governs Self A's directed selection decides whether to act on the proposal, ignore it, or request further analysis. Carry-through does not create automatic evolution; it creates governable opportunity for evolution.

Symmetry is essential to the governance value. A preserved conflict is not a verdict: it does not establish that one Self's approach is correct and the other's is in error. Both Selves encountered a boundary. Both Selves' approaches are candidates for potential evolution in light of the encounter. If the annotation went only to the Self whose approach was "out of step" with the other's, carry-through would implicitly adjudicate the conflict — assigning informational consequence asymmetrically, as if one position were the baseline and the other the deviation. The architecture does not make that adjudication. Each Self receives the annotation with full content; each Self's home governance evaluates independently; any convergence or divergence that follows is a governed outcome, not an automatic one.

5. The Claim 3 / Claim 4 overlap: carry-through as Locus 1 input

D1.16 sits at the boundary between two Paper 3 claims, and the note would be incomplete without acknowledging this architectural relationship explicitly.

Paper 3 Claim 4 establishes the four-locus evolution-feed mechanism: the architectural specification of how FAI events feed into participating Selves' home evolution machinery at dissolution. The four loci correspond to the channels through which FAI-derived content reaches existing Paper 2 evolution mechanisms at each home perimeter. Locus 1 — the action-feedback locus — specifies that action-layer content generated at or from FAI events enters each participating Self's home action-feedback evolution machinery. Conflict carry-through annotations are action-layer content. They are generated at FAI dissolution. They enter home action-feedback evolution by the same Locus 1 channel.

This means D1.16 is simultaneously a Claim 3 sub-commitment (addressing what happens to preserved conflicts within the three-tier conflict-handling mechanism) and an instance of Claim 4's Locus 1 specification (action-layer content generated at FAI dissolution entering home action-feedback evolution). The two claims overlap precisely at D1.16.

The overlap is architecturally significant rather than a classificatory anomaly. It shows that Claim 3 and Claim 4 are not independent mechanisms operating in parallel but jointly specified commitments that compose coherently at the dissolution boundary. Claim 3 specifies how conflicts are handled during an FAI event; Claim 4 specifies how FAI-event content reaches home evolution at dissolution; D1.16 specifies the pathway that connects them at the preserved-conflict case. The architecture is coherent at this joint: every preserved conflict produces content (the annotation) that flows through a precisely specified channel (Locus 1 of the evolution feed) to a precisely specified destination (home action-feedback evolution) under precisely specified governance (home governance authority over directed selection).

6. Four failure modes the sub-commitment defends against

Preserved conflict loss at dissolution. The most direct failure mode is the absence of any carry-through mechanism: preserved conflicts exist as first-class substrate state during an FAI event and are simply discarded when the shared substrate dissolves. This failure mode leaves the preserve tier informationally incomplete. Participating Selves return to home governance with no record of the boundary they encountered, no information about the other Self's approach, and no basis for evolution. The architectural commitment that preserved conflicts produce home-substrate annotations is the direct defense.

Non-home-governed annotation processing. A carry-through mechanism that routes annotations to automated processing pipelines outside each Self's home governance structure would satisfy the letter of carry-through while violating its governance value. If annotations are processed by an orchestration layer, a shared coordination service, or any component not subject to each participating Self's home governance authority, the annotations' content is not available to home governance as the actionable evidence D1.16 intends. The sub-commitment specifies that carry-through annotations are action-layer content subject to home governance — not content processed by external infrastructure.

Asymmetric carry-through. A carry-through mechanism that delivers annotations only to the Self whose aspect specification was "overridden" or "out of step" with the other's would implicitly adjudicate preserved conflicts. It would treat one Self's approach as the baseline and the other's as the deviation in need of correction, assigning informational consequence asymmetrically. D1.16 defends against this by specifying that carry-through goes to all participating Selves, with each annotation carrying both sides of the preserved conflict. No Self is pre-identified as the party with revision obligations.

Annotation without provenance. A carry-through annotation that records only the conflict content — the two sides of the disagreement — without linking back to the FAI event from which it arose would be untraceably detached from its coordination context. Governance decisions about whether and how to respond to the annotation depend on context: which event, under what configuration, between which Selves, at what scope. An annotation without provenance cannot support the accountability chain that path-retraceability requires and may be too context-free to be actionable for home governance. The sub-commitment specifies that each annotation carries a provenance link to the originating FAI event.

7. Operational test

A system instantiates the D1.16 conflict carry-through sub-commitment if and only if, after an FAI event that included one or more preserved conflicts, all of the following are true:

1. An observer can locate a conflict carry-through annotation in *each* participating Self's home action layer — not only in the home substrate of one Self, but in every Self that participated in the FAI event.

2. Each annotation can be verified as containing both sides of the preserved conflict: the aspect specification contributed by each participating Self to the domain in which the conflict arose, not just a description of the disagreement or one side of it.

3. Each annotation contains a provenance link that can be traced back to the specific FAI event from which it arose, including the event's identity and the aspect contributions from which the conflict emerged.

4. The annotations are action-layer content subject to each participating Self's home governance: they are accessible to each Self's home action-feedback evolution machinery, and any response to them — improvement proposals, directed selection decisions — is governed by home governance authority rather than by an external orchestration layer.

5. No participating Self was excluded from the annotation distribution on the grounds that its approach was "correct" or "baseline" relative to the other participants' approaches.

A system in which preserved conflicts produce no home-substrate record, produce records only in some participating Selves' home substrates, produce records without provenance, or produce records processed by infrastructure outside home governance does not satisfy the D1.16 sub-commitment regardless of whether its conflict-handling mechanism preserves conflicts as first-class substrate state during FAI events.

8. Closing the Claim 3 sub-commitment set

D1.16 completes the four-note sub-commitment decomposition of Paper 3 Claim 3.

D1.13 (preserve tier) formalized that conflicts surfaced during FAI events remain first-class addressable substrate state as the architectural default, with neither automatic resolution nor automatic discard as the system behavior.

D1.14 (resolve tier) formalized that conflicts of known classes are dispatched by orchestration rules authored as substrate content under joint authority across participating Selves' governance, with resolution logic owned by the substrate rather than the LLM.

D1.15 (escalate tier) formalized that conflicts for which no automated resolution is permitted surface to the governance authorities of participating Selves, with the cross-perimeter joint-authority shape as the genuinely fresh tier shape Paper 3 introduces.

D1.16 (this note) formalizes what happens to preserved conflicts at dissolution: they carry through to each participating Self's home substrate as action-layer annotations, feeding into home action-feedback evolution as governance-actionable boundary signals, with symmetric distribution, complete content, and FAI provenance as the three annotation requirements.

Together, D1.13 through D1.16 cover the full behavioral envelope of Claim 3: what happens when a conflict is first surfaced (preserve as default), what happens when an automated response is appropriate (resolve via orchestration), what happens when human judgment is required (escalate), and what happens when a preserved conflict reaches dissolution (carry-through to home evolution). The four sub-commitments are jointly complete: no conflict surfaced during an FAI event falls outside the three tiers, and no preserved conflict reaching dissolution falls outside the carry-through commitment.

Phase D1 continues at D1.17 with the first sub-commitment of Paper 3 Claim 4 — the four-locus evolution-feed mechanism at the FAI hand-off boundary.

Series D derivation notes formalize the sub-commitments of Paper 3's six named architectural claims. Each note states one sub-commitment precisely, identifies the failure modes it defends against, and provides an operational test. The series does not introduce new axioms; it articulates what the source papers commit to at the level of precision needed for downstream work to adopt, implement, or argue against the commitments without ambiguity.